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OPR: WVOT Cybersecurity

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

Publications are available online at
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Questions and change recommendations related to this publication shall be directed to this publication's Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR). This policy shall be reviewed annually to ensure continued alignment with current legal, operational, and strategic requirements. Revisions will be undertaken as necessary.

SUMMARY OF VERSIONS AND CHANGES

Version	Date	Revision Description
1	7/01/2015	Changed name from Anti-Virus to Malicious Software Protection: Added Change Log History, Related Documents/Materials, and Policy-Specific Definitions; Added paragraphs 3.9-3.12
2	09/01/2016	Reviewed - No Changes
3	10/20/2017	Reviewed - No Changes
4	12/31/2023	Updated website link
5	03/13/2026	Reformatted - Minor Administrative Changes

1. PURPOSE

1.1. This policy prescribes the measures required to counter malicious software (malware), such as computer viruses, and identifies the responsibilities in protecting the State network against malicious software. This protection includes the tools and procedures necessary to prevent major and widespread damage to user applications, files, desktops, workstations, and laptops/notebooks, which are either physically or remotely connected to the State network via a standard network, wireless, modem, or through virtual private network (VPN).

2. SCOPE

2.1. This policy applies to all departments (including agencies, boards, authorities, and commissions) within the Executive Branch of WV State Government, excluding constitutional officers, the WV Board of Education, the WV Department of Education, and the county boards of education that have access to or use State-provided resources.

2.2. Where there are policies in place which provide less restrictions or security than this policy, those policies will be superseded by this policy. In instances where existing state and federal laws, regulations, and policies are more restrictive than this policy, the more restrictive provisions will prevail.

3. POLICY

3.1. Malicious code protection mechanisms will be employed at critical information system entry and exit points (e.g., firewalls, electronic mail servers, web servers, proxy servers, remote-access servers, cloud environments) and at workstations, servers, or mobile computing devices on the network where feasible.

3.1.1. Any information system that stores, processes, or transmits Federal Tax Information (FTI), Personal Health Information (PHI), Social Security Numbers (SSN) or Personal Identity Information (PII) must be protected against malicious code transported by electronic mail, electronic mail attachments, Internet accesses, or other common means.

3.1.2. Data and program files that have been electronically transmitted to a WVOT-supported resource from another location, whether internal or external, will be automatically scanned for viruses/malware.

3.2. WVOT will evaluate, procure, install, and maintain endpoint detection and response (EDR) software and/or tools for use on all WVOT supported equipment.

3.2.1. All software must be installed by WVOT authorized employees.

3.2.2. Employees will only use software provided by the State.

3.3. Employees must not intentionally introduce malware, such as viruses, onto State computing equipment or systems, or withhold information necessary for effective malware control procedures.

3.4. Employees must not attempt to alter or disable anti-virus software, or attempt to terminate any scan being performed by EDR , on any system attached to the Executive network.

3.5. Employees should use extreme caution when executing programs or opening email attachments that:

3.5.1. Have not been requested; or

3.5.2. Come from an unknown source.

3.6. Employees will immediately notify the WVOT Service Desk if they have reason to believe their device may be infected with a virus or malware.

3.7. The WVOT will configure systems to prevent users from disabling EDR software updates.

3.8. Real-time protection of resources must be continuously performed.

3.9. Real-time scans must be performed on files from external sources that are downloaded, opened, or executed in accordance with agency security policy.

3.10. Known malicious code and software will be blocked or quarantined.

3.11. WVOT will manage malicious code protection mechanisms and automatically update these protection mechanisms as needed.

4. POLICY SPECIFIC DEFINITIONS

4.1. Chief Information Officer (CIO) - the person designated by the governor to lead the WV Office of Technology and oversee information technology practices and initiatives for the Executive Brand of WV State government, excluding the constitutional officers.

4.2. Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) - Person designated by the CTO to oversee information security practices and initiatives for the Executive Branch of WV State government, excluding the constitutional officers.

4.3. Malware – A piece of malicious software that is designed to cause some unexpected or undesirable event, and is generally introduced to a system without the knowledge or consent of the user.

4.4. Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) - The primary section within WVOT that takes the lead on a specific policy or procedure. Usually the WVOT service provider/owner that the policy is related to or governs.

4.5. Scan – To examine computer coding/programs sequentially, part by part. For viruses, scans are made for virus signatures or potentially unsafe practices (e.g., changes to an executable file, direct writes to specific disk sectors, et. al.).

4.6. Subject Matter Expert(SME) - Someone with extensive, specialized knowledge and experience in a particular area, process, or topic.

4.7. West Virginia Office of Technology (WVOT) - The division of the Department of Administration established by WV Code § 5A-6-4a, et. seq., which is led by the State's CIO and designated to acquire, operate, and maintain the State's technology infrastructure. The WVOT is responsible for evaluating equipment and services, and reviewing information technology contracts.

4.8. Workstation – A personal computer; also called a PC.

5. RELEVANT MATERIALS AND DOCUMENTS

5.1. 45 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) §§ 164.308-316

5.2. Freedom of Information Act

5.3. Gramm-Leach Bliley Act (GLBA)

5.4. Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Privacy Rule

5.5. NIST SP 800-14 and NIST SP 800-53

5.6. State Health Privacy Laws

5.7. WV Code § 5A-6-4a

5.8. WV Executive Order No. 7-03

5.9. WVOT Policies Issued by the Chief Information Officer (CIO), https://sites.google.com/wv.gov/othub/policy-governance/ot-policies